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Lesson 36 A chance in a million

百万分之一的机遇 独立主格

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credulous / ˈkredʒələs / adj. 轻信的
obscure / əbˈskjʊə(r) / adj. 不起眼的
presume * / prɪˈzjuːm / v. 假定

plot / plɒt / v. 密谋
naive / naɪˈiːv / adj. 天真的

conspire / kənˈspaɪə(r) / v. (事件)巧合促成
resemblance / rɪˈzemblәns / n. 相似
acquaint / əˈkweɪnt / v. 使了解
assume * / əˈsjuːm / v. 假定，认为

improbable / ɪmˈprɒbəbl / adj. 不大可能的
maidservant / ˈmeɪdsɜːvənt / n. 女仆，女佣
wickedly / ˈwɪkɪdli / adv. 心眼坏地，居心叵测地
downfall / ˈdaʊnfɔːl / n. 倒台，垮台
unacceptable / ˌʌnəkˈseptəbl / adj. 不能接受的
incredible / ɪnˈkredəb(ə)l / adj. 不可思议的
scorn / skɔːn / n. 嘲弄，挖苦
reunite / ˌriːjuˈnaɪt / v. 使团聚

感悟 (笔记最后修改于:2024-06-14 15:04:14) 5

※ A chance in a million 夸张修饰（机会渺茫）

- I'd love to buy a Rolls-Royce, but it **costs an arm and a leg**.
- Everybody **was clapping their hands off**.
- I **didn't sleep a wink last night**.
- He has **a skeleton of a wife**.

※ We are less credulous than we used to be (credulous).

People are not so honest as they once were.

- We spend more time traveling **than** we used to (spend).

『**less + adj. / adv. + than ...** 不像...那样』

- This task is **less** difficult **than** the previous one. 这个任务比上一个任务不那么难。
- She arrived **less** quickly **than** he did. 她到达的速度比他慢。

『**not so / as + adj. / adv. + as ...** 不像...一样』

- This book is not **so** interesting **as** the one I read last week. 这本书不像我上周读的那本那么有趣。
- He didn't run **as** fast **as** his brother. 他的跑步速度不像他兄弟那么快。
- We are not **so** / **as** credulous **as** we used to be. 替换

> He is **less** introverted **than** he used to be. 他不像以前那么内向了。
> He is not **so** / **as** introverted **as** he used to be.
> He speaks English **less** well **than** he used to. 他英语说的不如以前好了。
> He doesn't speak English **so** / **as** well **as** he used to.

※ In the nineteenth century, a novelist would bring his story to a conclusion by presenting his readers with a series of coincidences — most of them wildly improbable.

would 过去常常	used to do 过去常常
都可以表示过去习惯性的动作 One day in a week he would spend a whole day in silence.	
would 不能用在故事开头	往往在故事开头用 used to do，而后面换为 would do
We **used to work** in the same office and we **would** often have coffee together.	

『**bring sth. to a conclusion** 使某事结束、完成某事』

- The two countries decided to **bring** the war **to a conclusion**. 两国决定**结束**战争。
- The team worked hard to **bring** the project **to a conclusion**. 团队努力工作以使项目结束。

come to a conclusion 得出结论	After much debate, they finally **came to a conclusion**. 经过长时间的讨论，他们终于得出了结论。
arrive at a conclusion 得出结论	The scientists **arrived at a conclusion** after analyzing the data. 科学家们在分析数据后得出了结论。
reach a conclusion 得出结论	The jury **reached a conclusion** after several hours of deliberation. 陪审团经过数小时的商议后达成了结论。
draw a conclusion 得出结论；作结论	Based on the evidence, the detective **drew a conclusion**. 根据证据，侦探得出了结论。

『**bring sth. to a close / an end** 强调的是渐进性的结束，通常涉及到某种逐步的终结。』

- The chairman's speech **brought** the meeting **to a close**. 主席的讲话结束了会议。
- The negotiations finally **brought** the conflict **to an end**. 谈判最终结束了冲突。
- The rally was **brought to a close** / **an end** by the singing of the national anthem.

> ..., a novelist would **end** / **close** / **conclude** his story by ... 替换

End	各种情境下的结束	The concert **ended** with a spectacular fireworks display.
Close	强调有序或正式的结束，常见于仪式、会议等场合	Please **close** the door when you leave.
Conclude	强调达成结论或结束，常见于讨论、研究、调查等	We **concluded** our business negotiations with a signed agreement.

『bring ... to ... 把前者带到后者的状态』

- It was the war that first **brought** him **to** power.
- So far the US has been unable to **bring** him **to** justice.

present sb. with sth. 把某物给予某人	They **presented** him **with** a gift for his retirement. 他们送给他一份退休礼物。
present sth. to sb. 把某物给予某人	He entered the cell and **presented** the letter **to** the aristocrat.

『series of 一系列；一连串』

- **an** unforeseen **series of** catastrophes
- There was **a series of** delays due to bad weather. 由于恶劣天气，出现了一连串的延误。
- She noticed **a train of** thought in his argument. 她注意到他论点中的一连串思路。
- The speaker delivered **a string of** jokes to entertain the audience. 演讲者讲了一连串的笑话来取悦观众。
- There was **a chain of** events that led to his resignation. 一连串的事件导致了他的辞职。
- The detective found **a trail of** clues leading to the suspect. 侦探找到了一串线索，指向嫌疑人。
- There was a **stream of** people leaving the concert hall. 有一波人从音乐厅离开。

『by coincidence 巧了、碰巧的是』

- My mother is called Anna, and **by coincidence** my wife's mother is called Anna too.

『coincide with sth. 与...一致（两个事碰巧一起发生、一致）』

- My arrival **coincided with** his departure.
- If our schedules **coincide**, we'll go to Shanghai together.

『most of them being wildly improbable 独立主格』

> — most of them were wildly improbable. ×
> — **and** / **but** most of them were wildly improbable. ✓
> — most of **which** were wildly improbable.✓

- Apart from an interesting-looking carved dagger, the box was full of crockery, **much of it broken**.

> 造句：The archaeologists found fifteen statues, **each of them representing a goddess**.考古学家
> 发现了十五尊雕像，每一尊代表着一位女神。

※ Readers happily accepted the fact that an obscure maidservant was really the hero's mother.

Readers happily accepted	the fact	that an obscure maidservant was really the hero's mother.
主 + 谓	所解释的抽象名词	同位语从句

※ A long-lost brother, who was presumed dead, was really alive all the time and wickedly plotting to bring about the hero's downfall.

『**plot** n.阴谋，密谋 v.密谋，暗中策划』

- a **plot** to assassinate the President 暗杀总统的阴谋
- All the imperialist **schemes and intrigues** are doomed to failure.
- schemes and intrigues 阴谋诡计
- scheme v.密谋，策划 n.阴谋，诡计
- intrigue v. 密谋 n.密谋策划，阴谋
- conspiracy n.合谋，密谋；阴谋集团

> and wickedly **plotting** to → ... and wickedly **scheming** / ~~conspiring~~ to... 替换

『**be presumed dead / innocent ...** 被推定为死亡/无辜...』

- Their nephew was missing, **presumed** dead.
- In English law, an accused man **is presumed innocent** until he is proved guilty.
- After days of searching, he **was presumed dead**.经过几天的搜索，他被推定为已故。
- In legal proceedings, the defendant **is presumed innocent** until proven guilty. 在法律程序中，被告被推定为无罪，直到被证明有罪。

『**alive** adj.活着的；仍然存在的（以a开头的形容词，通常只能做表语、补语）』

- He may hunt, beg, or steal occasionally to **keep himself alive**, ...

- He has been able to tell us more about active volcanoes than any man **alive**.

『 **living** adj.活着的，活的；在使用的（可做定语修饰名词） 』

- all **living** things 生物
- **living** proof 活生生的证据
- At such times, justice acts like a **living** force.

live	adj.活的，有生命的	/ laɪv / 来物	• experiments on **live** animals 活体动物试验 • be transmitted live 现场直播 • Is the wire **live**? 电线通电了吗? • A **live** audience will pose the questions. 一位现场观众将会提些问题。
	v.生存，活着	/ lɪv / 立物	• Where do you **live**? 你住在哪里? • I **live** in a very old town which is surrounded by beautiful woods. • My parents used to **live in** South America, and I used to fly there from Europe during the holidays.

『 **downfall** n. fall from a position of prosperity or power 』

- Greed led to his **downfall**. 贪婪导致了他的垮台。

『 **downfall** n. thing that causes this 』

- His vanity was his **downfall**.他的虚荣心使他堕落。

『 **undoing** n.毁灭；取消；毁灭的原因 』

- The team's weak defense was their **undoing**.
- That proved to be my **undoing**, for I soon got back to my old bad habit of dozing off in front of the screen. NCE3-50

※ And so on. 如此等等、诸如此类

- and so forth
- and the like
- and what not
- etc. (et cetera)

※ Modern readers would find such naive solutions totally unacceptable.

『 improbable → incredible → unbelievable → unacceptable 发展进程 』

> Modern readers would find such naive solutions totally **unacceptable** / **improbable** / **incredible** / **unbelievable** / **inconceivable** / **unconvincing** / **preposterous**.

- Chinese students **would find such** easy examinations **totally incredible**. 中国学生会觉得这么简单的考试是完全无法相信的。
- Though the crew were at first under the impression that the lost ship had been found, the contents of the chest **proved** them **wrong**. 使用宾补避免使用从句
- The facts **proved** their worries **unnecessary**. 事实证明他们的担心是多余的。
- The facts **proved** his accusations **totally groundless**. 事实证明他的指责毫无根据。
- If you lived in the Mediterranean, for instance, you would **consider** octopus **a great delicacy**.
- If you lived in the Northeast of China, you would **consider** skating **a great pleasure**. 如果你住在中国东北地区，你就会非常喜欢滑冰。
- She **would find such** a story **totally inconceivable**. 她会觉得这样的故事完全不可信。
- She **would find such** a claim **totally unbelievable**.她会觉得这样的说法完全难以置信。
- They **would find such** behavior t**otally improbable**.他们会觉得这样的行为完全不能接受。
- He **would find such** news **totally shocking**. 他会觉得这样的消息完全震惊。

※ Yet, in real life, circumstances do sometimes conspire to bring about coincidences which anyone but a nineteenth century novelist would find incredible.

『**in real life** 在现实生活中』

- in the real world 在现实世界中

『**circumstances** n.环境，状况』

- **Under no circumstances** should you approach that man.
- **Due to circumstances** beyond our control, ...

『**conspire to do sth.** 两个或以上的人表“合谋”，多件事一块儿促成某事发生（多数为不好的结果）』

- Falling demand and high interest rates have **conspired to** produce a big drop in profits.

『**but** prep.除了，除...外』

- anyone **but** a nineteenth century novelist 除了19世纪的小说家以外的其他人
- He didn't speak anything **but** Greek. 他除了希腊语之外不会说其他任何语言。
- Nobody **but** Robert would do such a thing.
- Who **but** a fool would do such a thing?
- His house is **the last but one** in the street.
- Take **the next turning but one** on your left.

『**but** 后可跟不定式（to） do』

> 前面如果有实义动词，后面的to就可以省略，如果没有就得写上完整的to do.

- We have nothing to **do** but **wait** here. 除了等在这里我们不能做其它事

- We have no choice but to wait here. 前面没有实义动词（have 在这里翻译不出来意思）

> 造句：In real life, circumstances do sometimes conspire to bring about a series of catastrophes which anyone but the victims would find incredible. 在现实生活中，有时确实很多情况会凑到一起导致一连串的大灾难，而这些事情除了受害者之外可能谁也不会相信。

生活比小说更离奇 (笔记最后修改于:2026-09-10 00:00:28) 3

※ When I was a boy, my grandfather told me how a German taxi driver, Franz Bussman, found a brother who was thought to have been killed twenty years before.

> When ~~I was~~ a boy 状语的主语要和主句一致才能省略，如果省略了主谓就变成了“我爷爷小时候”。

- In my childhood, ... 在我的童年（时间状语）
- In my early years, ...
- In my teens, ... 在我十几岁的时候（13-19 岁 thir**teen** ~ nine**teen**）
- In my adolescence, ...在我的青春期
- In my youth, ... 年轻时(16-24岁)

『 **to have + done** 动词不定式的完成时态（比谓语动词发生的时间更早）』

- Everyone went to the funeral, for the 'ghost' was none other than Eric Cox, a third brother who **was supposed to have died** as a young man.

※ While on a walking tour with his wife, he stopped to talk to a workman. 代述

stop doing 停止、不再...（常用且通俗）	She **stopped talking** when the teacher entered the room. 当老师走进教室时，她停止了说话。
stop to do 停下然后去做...	They **stopped to take** a break during the hike. 他们在徒步过程中停下来休息。
cease to do 停止做某事（比较正式）	I will never **cease to chase** / **cease chasing** / **stop chasing** after my dream.我永远不会停止追逐梦想。
cease doing 停止做某事（较为自然）	

※ After they had gone on, Mrs. Bussman commented on the workman's close resemblance to her husband and even suggested that he might be his brother.

『**comment on ...** 对...评论』

- I don't want to **comment on** other people's views.
- No comment. 无可奉告

comment that ... 评论说...	He **commented** that the movie was too long. 他评论说这部电影太长了。
remark on ... 发表评论性的看法	She **remarked on** the beautiful weather. 她评论了美好的天气。
remark that ... 引出某人的评论或观点	The professor **remarked** that the theory needed further research. 教授指出该理论需要进一步研究。

『**bear a close resemblance to ...** 与...非常相似』

- She **bears a close resemblance to** her grandmother. 她和她的祖母非常相像。

『**closely resemble ...** 极为相似：指两个或多个事物在外观、特征或性质上非常相似。』

> Mrs. Bussman **commented / remarked** that the workman **bore a close resemblance to her husband / closely resembled her husband**.

- The new model **closely resembles** the previous one. 新款与之前的款式非常相似。

※ Franz poured scorn on the idea, pointing out that his brother had been killed in action during the war.

『**pour scorn on ...** 对...不屑一顾；嘲笑』

- She **poured scorn on** his ridiculous idea. 她嘲笑了他那荒谬的想法。
- They **poured scorn on** the government's policy. 他们对政府的政策嗤之以鼻。

pour contempt on ... 蔑视	The critics **poured contempt on** the author's latest book. 评论家们对这位作者的新书嗤之以鼻。
pour ridicule on ... 对...嘲弄，挖苦，斥之以鼻	He **poured ridicule on** her suggestion during the meeting. 他在会议上嘲笑了她的建议。
pour cold water on ... 泼冷水(打消积极性)	The manager **poured cold water on** their plan, saying it was unrealistic. 经理泼了他们的计划冷水，说这不切实际。

> Franz didn't **take the idea seriously**,**reminding** her that his brother had been killed ... 替换

『**point out** 指出，提及』

- I must **point out** that you are making a dangerous mistake.
- At this, the police **pointed out** ironically that this would hardly be necessary as the men were already under arrest.
- Anyway, as Brian **pointed out**, it is the easiest thing in the world to give up smoking.
- He has **pointed out** that the tree is a useful source of income, as tourists have been coming from all parts of the country to see it.

※ Though Mrs. Bussman was fully acquainted with this story, she thought that there was a chance in a million that she might be right.

『**be acquainted with ...** 了解或熟悉某事物』

- She **is well acquainted with** the latest research in her field.她对自己领域的最新研究非常熟悉。
- I **am acquainted with** his work through his published articles.我通过他的发表文章了解他的工作。
- They **are acquainted with** each other from college. 他们在大学时就认识。

be familiar with ... 熟悉；精通；通晓；与...很熟悉	Though Mrs. Bussman **was fully familiar with** this story, ... 可替换

> .., she thought there was, **the slightest / remotest** chance that she might be right.

『**a chance in a million** 百万分之一的机遇、千载难逢、极小的机会』

1. **A needle in a haystack** 指的是在一大堆东西中找到的极其罕见的东西或事件。
2. **A shot in the dark** 指的是没有仔细考虑的、没有把握的尝试。
3. **Slim to none** 指的是几乎没有机会或希望。
4. **Once in a blue moon** 指的是非常罕见的事情，类似于月蚀过后的蓝色月亮。
5. **Like finding a four-leaf clover** 指的是像找到四叶草一样的罕见事件或机会。
6. **A snowball's chance in hell** 指的是几乎没有任何可能性，比如在地狱里雪球的机会一样渺茫。
7. **As rare as hen's teeth** 指的是非常罕见的事物，因为鸡没有牙齿，所以比喻非常罕见。

> 造句：Though the detective **was fully acquainted with** the fact that the old lady was always so kind to everybody, he thought that there was **a chance in a million** that she might be the murderer.尽管这位侦探非常了解这位老太太对周围每一个人总是这么好，但他认为仍有一丝可能这位老太太就是谋杀犯。

※ A few days later, she sent a boy to the workman to ask him if his name was Hans Bussman.

『**send sb. to sw. to do** 派某人去某地做某事』

- She **sent** him **to** Paris **to** negotiate the deal.她派遣他去巴黎谈判交易。
- The company **sent** their engineers **to** the site **to** assess the damage.公司派遣他们的工程师去现场评估损坏情况。

- He was **sent to** New York **to** represent the team at the conference.他被派往纽约代表团队参加会议。
- They **sent** her **to** the store **to** buy groceries.他们派她去商店买菜。

※ Needless to say, the man's name was Hans Bussman and he really was Franz's long-lost brother.

needless to say 不必说

- **Needless to say** our house is now surrounded by a jungle. NCE3-46

as you can imagine 正如你所能想象的	Because, **as you can imagine**, in-depth research often requires monetary support.因为，正如您可以想象的那样，深入的研究通常需要资金支持。

※ When the brothers were reunited, Hans explained how it was that he was still alive.

『**be reunited (with ...)** (与...)团聚』

- She and her youngest son were finally allowed to **be reunited with** their family.她和她的小儿子最终被允许和他们的家庭团聚。
- The lost children **were reunited with** their parents.

『**how it was = how it happened** 怎样发生的(怎么回事)』

- She described **how it was** when they first met.她描述了他们初次见面时的情况。
- He explained **how it was** growing up in a small town.他解释了他在小镇长大的情况。
- She explained **how it happened** that they missed their flight.她解释了他们错过飞机的原因。
- He told us **how it happened** that he became a doctor.他告诉我们他是如何成为医生的。

> 造句： When Eric returned to the farm, he explained **how it was** that he deserted his regiment.
> 当Eric回到农场后，他解释了他是怎么从团里逃出来的。

※ After having been wounded towards the end of the war, he had been sent to hospital and was separated from his unit.

> After he **had been wounded**, ...

『**towards / toward midnight** 逐渐接近...』

- **Towards** midday, a girl heard a muffled cry coming from behind one of the walls.
- They were all moving **toward** him down the stairs. 他们都正朝着他走下楼梯。
- There was a forecast of cooler weather **toward** the end of the week. 天气预报说接近周末时天气会更凉爽。
- Gulls are nesting on a small island **toward** the eastern shore. 海鸥正在靠近东海岸的一个小岛上筑巢。

『 **send sb. to hospital** 送某人去医院(零冠词：强调功能、美语中会使用a、the) 』

- She fell down the stairs and had to **be sent to hospital** immediately.她摔下了楼梯，必须立即送往医院。
- The accident was severe enough **to send** several people **to the hospital**.事故严重到足以送几个人去医院。
- He **was sent to the hospital** for surgery on his leg.他因腿部手术而被送往医院。

take sb. to hospital 送某人去医院治疗	A man who had broken his right leg was **taken to hospital** a few weeks before Christmas.
take sb to the hospital 送某人去医院	They **took him to the hospital** after the accident.他们在事故发生后把他送到了医院。
be in hospital 住院	She **has been in hospital** for a week recovering from surgery.她已经住院一周了，正在康复中。
be hospitalized 住院、入院	He **was hospitalized** with a severe case of pneumonia.他因为重症肺炎而住院。
be out of / leave hospital 出院	After two weeks of treatment, she **was** finally **out of hospital**.经过两周的治疗，她终于出院了。

『 **separate ... from ...** 分离：指将某物与其他事物分开或切断。 』

- Theory should never **be separated from** practice.

cut ... off from ... 断绝来往、隔绝	She realized that he was trying to **cut** her **off from** her friends.
isolate ... from ... 使隔离、使孤立	He **was isolated from** all the other prisoners.
segregate ... from ... （人种、宗教、信仰）隔离	Blacks **were segregated from** whites in every area of life.

※ The hospital had been bombed and Hans had made his way back into Western Germany on foot.

『 **make one's way** 前往某地 』

- I **made my way** to the house.
- I **made my way** into the backyard.
- I **made my way** along the river.
- I **made my way** up the stairs.
- I **made my way** back into Western.

- Turning back down the main street, we quickened our pace and **made our way** rapidly towards the stream where we hoped the boatman was waiting. NCE3-48

feel one's way 摸索前进	The room was dark, so I had to **feel my way** along the wall to the door.
edge one's way 侧身前进	They had to **edge their way** along this,sometimes wading across shallow streams, or swimming across deep pools. NCE3-42
force / elbow one's way 从人群中挤过去	He **forced** / **elbowed his way** through the crowd.
find one's way (事物做主语)到达某地	Very few of the fifty pence pieces and pound coins I have given him **have found their way** there.
wind one's way 蜿蜒前进	The river **winds its way** through the valley.
trace one's way 蜿蜒前进	We expected the path to end abruptly, but we found that it **traced its way** through the trees. NCE3-48

※ Meanwhile, his unit was lost and all records of him had been destroyed.

『**be lost** 丢失，迷路；失传、走失、失败、击溃』

- It can feel strange to **be lost**.迷路的感觉会令人不安。
- The child **was lost** and began to whimper. 那孩子迷了路，抽抽搭搭地哭起来。
- He missed the catch and the game **was lost**. 他没接住球，输了这场比赛。

※ Hans returned to his family home, but the house had been bombed and no one in the neighbourhood knew what had become of the inhabitants.

『**become of sb./sth.** 关于...的情况、下落』

- What has become of Jane? ≈ How is Jane?
- Whatever **became of** the parcel you sent? 你寄的包裹怎么样了?

> No one in the neighborhood knew his family's **whereabouts**.

- Despite numerous searches and enquiries, her **whereabouts** are still unknown.

『**inhabit** v.居住于，栖居在；存在于，占据』

- In the future, people may **inhabit** other planets, then become the **inhabitants**.

cohabit with ...	In the future, people may **cohabit with** other species on other planets, then become the **cohabitants**.

※ Assuming that his family had been killed during an air raid, Hans settled down in a village fifty miles away where he had remained ever since.

assuming (that)	..以为	**Assuming (that)** the man was making a homosexual advance, he stormed out of the house angrily.
	假定，假如	**Assuming (that)** the house is for sale,would you buy it?

> You can stretch your legs on the spacious decks, play games, swim, meet interesting people and enjoy good food—always **assuming**, of course, **that** the sea is calm. NCE3-44

『**even assuming (that) ... = even if ...** 即使、就算...』

- **Even assuming (that)** smokers do see the health warnings, I doubt they'll take any notice.

『**settle down** 定居下来(结婚生子)』

- He had often dreamed of retiring in England and had planned to **settle down** in the country.

> Hans settled down in a village 50 miles away **and he** had remained **there** ever since. 看看where到底省略了哪些内容



apple of my eye

掌上明珠;心中挚爱

Idioms

课后练习题 (解题方法与答案需要在“ncego.com”笔记官网查看)

1. Very few people could understand his lecture because it was very ——— .(单选题)

A、 faint　B、 obscure　C、 gloomy　D、 indefinite

2. His tastes and habits ——— with those of his wife.(单选题)

A、 combine　B、 compete　C、 coincide　D、 compromise

3. It is fortunate for the old couple that their son's career goals and their wishes for him ——— .(单选题)

A、 coincide　　**B**、 comply　　**C**、 conform　　**D**、 collaborate

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请发送邮件至 hibenba@gmail.com 或直接访问官网 (**ncego.com**) 提交错误举报。

“一场孤独的修行，需要相信积累的力量。专注当下、珍惜时间、顶峰相见。”